

Case Study: A Prompt Hygiene Near-Miss

By Jack Peduzzi

What happened?

- An Analyst at Meridian Trust Bank almost pasted a transaction log containing customer data
- This would most likely violate the companies data-handling policy because of the sensitive data being sent to the AI.
- Many times, companies use locally hosted AI's like Microsoft Copilot so that data is not sent to an external place.



How did the analyst avoid this mistake?

- The analyst decided to replace the sensitive customer data with placeholder information.
- Even though placeholder data was used, the AI output still produced meaningful and actionable results for the analyst and the company.



What can be learned from this?

- By practicing good prompt hygiene, the analyst was still able to produce a good result.
- Sensitive data should not be sent to an AI agent, as the data can be stored on the AI companies servers.
- Always think before you send, similar to how you should always think before you speak.

LESSONS
LEARNED

